

Business Rules Expenses and Benefits 2025/26 P46(Car)

These Business Rules apply to live filing submissions from 06/04/2026

Introduction

Purpose of this Document

This document is intended to illustrate the structure, format and validation requirements necessary for the electronic filing of Expenses and Benefits forms.

The business requirements of HMRC and the demands of back-end systems drive the validation requirements.

Within this document is a listing of all data items required for the electronic equivalent of the form P46 Car.

Validation Rules for electronic EXB P46 Car returns via the Internet Service.

The following rules apply to all submissions made via the Internet:

Character Set

For the designated character set please refer to the XML schema for exact details.

All amounts are expressed in pounds and pence. The stated length for an amount field does not include the decimal point. For example, for the field length 'max 5' will be shown as '999.99' or if specified in whole pounds as '999.00'.

Field Status

Mandatory indicates that the information must be supplied to comply with requirements. Optional indicates that information should be supplied depending on the case and in certain conditions.

Changelog below records the changes made from the 2024/25 product to the 2025/26 product

Front Page- year changed from 2024/25 to 2025/26

These Business rules apply to live submissions from 06/04/2025 changed to These Business rules apply to live filing submissions from 06/04/2026.

Column name	Content
Data item name	1. Employer Name
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/Employer/Name
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	Max 35
Format	—
Business Rules	1. 1st character must be present and not space 2. Designated character set

P46 (Car) Data Items

Column name	Content
Data item name	2. Employee or Director Title
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/EmployeeDetails/Name/Ttl
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	O
Field length	Max 4
Format	—
Business Rules	1. If present, first character must be alpha Remaining characters must conform with the designated character set

Column name	Content
Data item name	3. Employee or Director First Forename
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/EmployeeDetails/Name/Fore
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	Max 35
Format	—
Business Rules	1. First character must be alpha Remaining characters must conform with the designated character set

Column name	Content
Data item name	4. Employee or Director Second Forename
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/EmployeeDetails/Name/Fore
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	O
Field length	Max 35
Format	—
Business Rules	1. If present, first character must be alpha Remaining characters must conform with the designated character set

Column name	Content
Data item name	5. Employee or Director Surname
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/EmployeeDetails/Name/Sur
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	Max 35
Format	—
Business Rules	1. First character must be alpha Remaining characters are a-z, A-Z, hyphen, apostrophe and space

Column name	Content
Data item name	6. Employee or Director National Insurance Number
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/EmployeeDetails/NINO
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	O
Field length	9
Format	—
Business Rules	1. The NINO should be in the format:- Characters 1 & 2 must be alpha and must be one of the issued National Insurance number prefixes (See Appendix 1) Characters 3 - 8 must be numeric Character 9 must be alpha and A, B, C, D or a space

Column name	Content
Data item name	7. Employee Date of Birth
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/EmployeeDetails/BirthDate
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	O
Field length	10
Format	ccyy-mm-dd
Business rules	1. Must be completed if the NINO is not known. If both date of birth and NINO are not known a default of 1st January 1901 should be used. 2. Must be a valid calendar date in the appropriate format. Must be today or earlier.

Column name	Content
Data item name	8. Employee Gender
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/EmployeeDetails/Gender
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	O
Field length	4 or 6
Format	male female
Business Rules	1. Must be completed if the NINO is not known. 2. Must indicate Male or Female in the appropriate format.

At least one of the indicators 1- 5 must be present.

Column name	Content
Data item name	9. First Car Indicator INDICATOR 1
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/SubmissionReason/ProvidedCar
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	O
Field length	2 or 3
Format	yes no
Business Rules	1. Allowable combinations of indicators: '1', '1 + 4'

Column name	Content
Data item name	10. Replacement Car Indicator INDICATOR 2
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/SubmissionReason/ReplacedCar/Replaced
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	O
Field length	2 or 3
Format	yes no
Business Rules	1. Allowable combinations of indicators: '2', '2 + 4'

Column name	Content
Data item name	11. Does This Employee Have More Than One Car?
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/SubmissionReason/ReplacedCar/MultipleCarIndicator
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	O
Field length	2 or 3
Format	yes no
Business Rules	1. Must be present if 'Replacement Car Indicator' (Indicator 2) is 'yes'

Column name	Content
Data item name	12. Make And Model of Car that has been Replaced
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/SubmissionReason/ReplacedCar/MultipleCars/MakeAndModel
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	Max 35
Format	—
Business Rules	1. Mandatory if the answer to 'Does the employee have more than one car' is 'yes' 2. Designated character set

Column name	Content
Data item name	13. Actual Engine Size of Car that has been Replaced (cc)
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/SubmissionReason/ReplacedCar/MultipleCars/EngineSize
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	Max 4
Format	—
Business Rules	1. Mandatory if the answer to 'Does the employee have more than one car' is 'yes' 2. Enter the Actual Engine Size of the replacement car i.e. 1600cc. 3. If the car has no engine size i.e. Electric Car, enter '0'

Column name	Content
Data item name	14. Engine Size of Car that has been Replaced - (Category Indicator)
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/SubmissionReason/ReplacedCar/MultipleCars/@Category
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	1
Format	1 2 3 4
Business Rules	1. Mandatory if the 'Engine Size' field has been completed 2. Acceptable Values for Target System = '1' (Up to 1400cc), '2' (1401 – 2000cc), '3' (2001cc or more), '4' (0 (No engine size e.g. electric car) 3. Category entered must correspond to the entry made in the 'Engine Size' Field.

Column name	Content
Data item name	15. Second / Further Car Indicator INDICATOR 3
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/SubmissionReason/SecondCar
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	O
Field length	2 or 3
Format	yes no
Business Rules	1. Allowable combinations of indicators: '3', '3 + 4'

Column name	Content
Data item name	16. Director Indicator INDICATOR 4
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/SubmissionReason/Director
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	O
Field length	2 or 3
Format	yes no
Business Rules	Allowable combinations of indicators: '4', '1 + 4', '2 + 4' '3 + 4

Column name	Content
Data item name	17. Car Withdrawn Indicator INDICATOR 5
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/SubmissionReason/CarWithdrawn/Withdrawn
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	3
Format	yes
Business Rules	Allowable combinations of indicators: '5'

Column name	Content
Data item name	18. Date The Car Was Withdrawn
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/SubmissionReason/CarWithdrawn/DateWithdrawn
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	10
Format	ccyy-mm-dd
Business Rules	Mandatory if Indicator 5 is 'yes'

Column name	Content
Data item name	19. Make And Model of Car Withdrawn
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/SubmissionReason/CarWithdrawn/MakeAndModel
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	Max 35
Format	—
Business Rules	1. Mandatory if Indicator 5 is 'yes' 2. Designated character set

Column name	Content
Data item name	20. Actual Engine Size of Car Withdrawn (cc)
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/SubmissionReason/CarWithdrawn/EngineSize
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	Max 4
Format	—
Business Rules	1. Mandatory if 'Indicator 5' is 'yes' 2. Enter the Actual Engine Size of the car withdrawn i.e. 1600cc 3. If the car has no engine size i.e. Electric Car, enter '0'

Column name	Content
Data item name	21. Engine Size of Car that has been Withdrawn - (Category Indicator)
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/SubmissionReason/CarWithdrawn/EngineSize/@Category
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	1
Format	1 2 3 4
Business Rules	. Mandatory if the 'Engine Size' field has been completed . Acceptable Values for Target System = '1' (Up to 1400cc), '2' (1401 – 2000cc), '3' (2001cc or more), '4' (0 (No engine size e.g. electric car)) . Category entered must correspond to the entry made in the 'Engine Size' Field

If Indicator 5 is answered as 'yes' in Part 1, Parts 2, 3, 4 & 5 do not need to be completed. Go straight to Declaration Section.

Column name	Content
Data item name	22. Part 2 - Make and Model Of Car Provided
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/CarDetails/MakeAndModel
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	Max 35
Format	—
Business Rules	1. Must be present if any of Indicators 1 - 4 are 'yes' 2. Designated character set

Column name	Content
Data item name	23. Actual Engine Size of Car Provided (cc)
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/CarDetails/EngineSize
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	Max 4
Format	—
Business Rules	1. Mandatory if the answer to 'Does the employee have more than one car' is 'yes' 2. Enter the Actual Engine Size of the car provided i.e.1600cc 3. If the car has no engine size i.e. Electric Car, enter '0'

Column name	Content
Data item name	24. Engine Size of Car Provided - (Category Indicator)
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/CarDetails/EngineSize@Category
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	1
Format	1 2 3 4
Business Rules	1. Mandatory if the 'Engine Size' field has been completed 2. Acceptable Values for Target System = '1' (Up to 1400cc), '2' (1401 – 2000cc), '3' (2001cc or more), '4' (0 (No engine size e.g. electric car)) 3. Category entered must correspond to the entry made in the 'Engine Size' Field.

Column name	Content
Data item name	25. Date First Registered
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/CarDetails/DateFirstRegistered
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	10
Format	ccyy-mm-dd
Business Rules	1. Must be present if any of indicators 1 - 4 are 'yes' 2. Must not be later than 'Date of Submission.'

Column name	Content
Data item name	26. Fuel Type
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/CarDetails/FuelType
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	O
Field length	1
Format	F D A
Business Rules	1. Must be present if any of indicators 1 - 4 are 'yes' Acceptable Value = 'F' for Diesel cars which meet Euro 6d standard, 'D' for all other Diesel cars, 'A' for all other cars

Column name	Content
Data item name	27. Part 3 - CO2 Emissions
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/CO2Emissions/Emissions
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	Max 3
Format	
Business Rules	1. Can only be present if any of indicators 1-4 are 'yes' If this data item is not present then either 2. 'Was Car First Registered Before 1998?'or 3. 'No Approved CO2 Emissions Figure Indicator' must be present

Column name	Content
Data item name	27A. Zero Emission mileage
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/CO2Emissions/ZeroEmissionMileage
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	O
Field length	Max 4
Format	Numeric
Business Rules	1. Must not be present if outside the CO2 emissions range 1-50 g/km 2. Mandatory if CO2 emissions are within the range 1-50 (inclusive) g/km 3. Maximum Value 9999 & Minimum Value 0 4. Must be whole numbers

Column name	Content
Data item name	28. Was Car First Registered Before 1998?
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/CO2Emissions/Before1998
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	O
Field length	3
Format	Yes
Business Rules	1. Can only be present where any of indicators1-4 are 'yes' 2. Can only be present if 'Date First Registered' is earlier than 01.01.98 3. Mandatory if 'Date First Registered' is earlier than 01.01.98 4. Can only be present where 'CO2 Emissions' is blank

Column name	Content
Data item name	29. No Approved CO2 Emissions Figure Indicator
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/CO2Emissions/NoApproved
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	3
Format	yes
Business Rules	1. Can only be present where any of indicators1-4 are 'yes' 2. Can only be present if 'Date First Registered' is 01.01.98 or later 3. Can only be present where 'CO2 Emissions' is blank

Column name	Content
Data item name	30. Part 4 - List Price of Car
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/MonetaryDetails/CarPrice
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	Max 9
Format	9999999.00
Business Rules	1. Must be present if any of indicators 1 – 4 Part 1 are 'yes' 2. Numeric characters in the appropriate format 3. Must be whole pounds 4. Minimum price £1.00

Column name	Content
Data item name	31. Accessories Price
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/MonetaryDetails/AccessoriesPrice
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	O
Field length	Max 8
Format	999999.00
Business Rules	1. Can only be present if indicators 1 - 4 are 'yes' 2. Numeric characters in the appropriate format 3. Must be whole pounds

Column name	Content
Data item name	32. Date Car Was First Available
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/MonetaryDetails/DateFirstAvailable
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	10
Format	ccyy-mm-dd
Business Rules	1. Must be present if any of indicators 1 – 4 are ‘yes’ 2. Must be after start of Current Tax year 3. Cannot be later than ‘Date of Submission’ 4. Cannot be earlier than ‘Date First Registered’

Column name	Content
Data item name	33. Cash Forgone
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/MonetaryDetails/CashForgone
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	O
Field length	Max 9
Format	9999999.00
Business Rules	1. Can only be present if any of indicators 1 - 4 are ‘yes’ 2. Numeric characters in the appropriate format 3. Must be whole pounds 4. If present entry must be equal to or greater than 0.00

Column name	Content
Data item name	34. Employee Capital Contributions
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/MonetaryDetails/CapitalContributions
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	Max 6
Format	5000.00
Business Rules	1. Must be present if any of indicators 1 – 4 are 'yes' 2. Numeric characters in the appropriate format 3. Must be whole pounds 4. Maximum Value £5000.00

Column name	Content
Data item name	35. Amount Paid By Employee For Private Use Of Car
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/MonetaryDetails/PrivateUsePayment
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	O
Field length	9
Format	9999999.00
Business Rules	1. Can only be present if any of indicators 1 – 4 are 'yes' 2. Numeric characters in the appropriate format 3. If present entry must be greater than 0.00 4. Must be whole pounds

Column name	Content
Data item name	36. Interval of Payment
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/MonetaryDetails/PrivateUsePayment/@Interval
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	O
Field length	1
Format	W M Q Y
Business Rules	1. Can only be present if any of indicators 1 - 4 are 'yes' Acceptable values – 'W' = Weekly, 'M' = Monthly, 'Q' = Quarterly, 'Y' = Yearly 2. Mandatory if 'Amount Paid by Employee for Private Use of Car' is present

Column name	Content
Data item name	37. Part 5 - Fuel For Private Use Indicator
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/Fuel/PrivateUse
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	2 or 3
Format	Yes no
Business Rules	1. Can only be present if any of indicators 1 – 4 are 'yes'

Column name	Content
Data item name	38. Employee/Director Contributes To Fuel Cost?
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/P46Car/Fuel/FuelPaidByEmployee
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	O
Field length	2 or 3
Format	Yes no
Business Rules	1. Can only be present if any of indicators 1- 4 are 'yes' 2. Must be present if 'Fuel For Private Use Indicator' = 'yes' 3. Must not be present if "Fuel For Private Use Indicator" = 'no'

Column name	Content
Data item name	39. Declaration
Xpath	/IRenvelope/ExpensesAndBenefits/Declarations/P46CarDeclaration
Status (Mandatory or Optional)	M
Field length	3
Format	Yes
Business Rules	1. Must always be present and answered "yes" in the appropriate format

Appendix 1 – valid NINO prefix letters

Characters D, F, I, Q, U and V are not used as either the first or second letter of a NINO prefix

The letter O is not used as the second letter of a prefix

Prefixes BG, GB, KN, NK, NT, TN and ZZ are not to be used